

Rabea Hinsching

PhD Candidate in Economics | [E-Mail](#) | [Website](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

Research Interests: Development Economics, Natural Resources, Political Economy, Corporate Social Responsibility

Education

10/2022 – present	PhD in Economics University of East Anglia • Thesis: “Three Essays on Mining, Corporate Social Investment, and Local Development in South Africa” • Supervisors: Oana Borcan, Christa Brunnschweiler & Ben D’Exelle
07/2025 – 08/2025	Visiting PhD Researcher Gauteng City-Region Observatory
10/2019 – 04/2022	MSc Economics / Development Economics University of Leipzig and Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne
09/2016 – 07/2019	BSc Politics, Psychology, Law and Economics (PPLE) University of Amsterdam

Research Projects

- The Limits of Firm-Led Development: Evidence from South African Mining Communities
Job Market Paper / Chapter 1 of PhD Thesis
- Corporate Social Investment, Political Participation, and Trust in Local Government
Chapter 2 of PhD Thesis
- Can Large-Scale Mining Promote Public Good Provision? Evidence from South Africa’s Mining Reform
Chapter 3 of PhD Thesis
- Assessing the Impact of the Broad-Based Livelihood Programme in Gauteng’s East Rand Mining Communities
In collaboration with Umsizi Sustainable Solutions; Work-in-Progress
- Corporate Social Investment Tracker
Dataset of corporate social investment projects | [Beta Version](#)

Teaching Experience

03/2024 – 05/2026	Teaching Assistant University of East Anglia • Undergraduate: Environmental Economics, Statistics for Economists, Behavioural Finance • Postgraduate: Applied Methods for Impact Evaluation
09/2023 – 05/2026	Tutor The Brilliant Club • Teaching placements of own and pre-designed courses at local secondary schools.

Conferences and Summer Schools

09/2026	16th ifo Dresden Workshop on Regional Economics, ifo Dresden (Germany)
12/2025	Conference on the Future of Development Economics, University of Manchester (UK)
09/2025	Twenty-Fourth Summer School in International and Development Economics: Geo-economics, Natural Resources, and Development, Gargonza (Italy)
07/2024	Applied Econometrics for Spatial Economics – 22nd LSEG Summer School, Lisbon (Portugal)

Additional Experience

04/2026 – present	Data Research Assistant <i>Economic Inquiry</i>
2025/26	Postgraduate Research Committee Member University of East Anglia
2025/26	Co-Reviewer Nature Communications
2022	Volunteer (Weltwärts) Madikwe Rural Development Programme, South Africa
2020 – 2022	Student Research Assistant Fraunhofer IMW and IWH (Financial Markets Department)

Skills

Methods	Causal Inference, Event Studies, Spatial Analysis, Geospatial Data Analysis
Software	Stata, R, Python, QGIS, LaTeX, SPSS
Languages	German (native), English (proficient)